ONE-PAGE PREACHING OUTLINE

The Book in the Rubble

Huldah · 2 Kings 22:14–20

Primary text: 2 Kings 22:14–20 **Also read:** 2 Kings 22:1–23:30 · 2 Chronicles 34:1–33 · Deuteronomy 28–29 · Jeremiah 31:31–34 · Galatians 3:10–14 **Big idea:** The word of God found in the rubble wounds the proud, hears the humble, and points to the King who took its curse: Huldah spoke the word, Josiah reformed the nation, and Jesus bore the judgment. **Time:** 55–60 minutes, including a 3–5 minute response (6,858 words at about 120 wpm). **Aim:** From reading without hearing to letting the Word wound and reform us; from trusting our clean-up to trusting the King who took the curse.

MOVEMENT MAP

MIN	SECTION	BEATS AND TRANSITION
5	**Introduction: The book in the rubble**	622 BC. Manasseh's wreckage; Josiah, eight, does right; the temple is repaired; Hilkiah finds the Book of the Law; Shaphan reads it; the king tears his clothes. The book was in the house; the word was not in the heart. → *"Read it."*
7	**The king who tore his clothes**	Manasseh's idols and the temple's decay. The reform begins before the find; the word meets him in ordinary work. The covenant curses (Deut 28:15). "For me, and for the people, and for all Judah" (22:13). He believes the book enough to be afraid. → *"Who can tell us what God is saying?"*
8	**The woman in the Second Quarter**	Five officials—high priest, secretary, king's servant, two more—go to Huldah (22:14). Prophetess; wife of Shallum, keeper of the wardrobe; the Mishneh. "Thus says the LORD… Tell the man who sent you" (22:15). God is not bound to expected channels. The messenger is tested by the message. → *"She speaks."*
8	**The word she spoke**	Judgment on "this place," grounded in the book (22:16–17); the temple is no talisman (Jer 7:4). Then mercy because "your heart was tender" (22:19). *Rakh*: soft, woundable. "A grave in peace" — Josiah dies at Megiddo (23:29–30) but is buried before the fall. → *"Certain judgment; personal mercy."*
7	**The reform that could not save**	Covenant (23:1–3), purge (23:4–20), Passover (23:21–23). "No king like him" (23:25). Yet the wrath is not turned away (23:26–27). The law cannot atone; the heart is the problem (Gal 3:10–13). New covenant, new heart (Jer 31:33; Ezek 36:26–27). → *"The best reform cannot save."*
8	**The King who took the curse**	Jesus the true King: reads the book (Luke 4:21), cleanses the temple (John 2:19), becomes the Passover (1 Cor 5:7), is the Prophet like Moses (Deut 18:15; Acts 3:22). He takes the curse (Gal 3:13; 2 Cor 5:21). No condemnation (Rom 8:1); the Spirit writes the law within (Rom 8:3–4). → *"Come to the King."*
6	**Application: What do you do with a book that finds you?**	Let the Word wound you before it comforts you. Bring your fear to the place where God speaks. Do not despise the messenger. Do not stop at mourning; do the reform — but trust the King, not the reform. → *"Grace, then obedience."*
3	**The invitation**	Three people: the one who reads without hearing; the one hiding from the book; the one who has mourned but never come to the King. → *"His name is Jesus. He saves."*
5	**Response and closing**	Silence. Three questions: what have you avoided, whose voice have you dismissed, what reform is asked? One act this week. Care note for victims (Ps 34:18). Prayer. The book found Josiah; the King finds us. → *"Go and live under the book."*

Total: 57 minutes; 55–60 with normal variation.

LINES TO LAND

- "The book was in the house of God; the word was not in the heart of the people."
- "Your heart was tender."
- "The judgment is certain; the mercy is personal."
- "The best reform in Judah's history could not turn away the wrath."
- "The book found Josiah. The King finds us."

GUARDRAILS

- Do not invent the discovery scene or Huldah's biography; the text gives the delegation, names, Second Quarter, and oracle.
- Say "widely identified with Deuteronomy or a core," not "we know what the scroll was."
- Do not turn "a grave in peace" into prosperity; Josiah died in battle at Megiddo.
- Note Huldah's significance without a slogan; label rabbinic traditions as later.
- The gospel must be explicit: the cross, the resurrection, and the new heart. Do not end on "read your Bible more."

IF YOU MUST CUT

- **To 50 minutes:** trim 7 minutes; keep 22:19–20, the tender heart, Megiddo, 23:26–27, Galatians 3:13, and the empty tomb.